

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Comparative Politics; Digital Politics; Artificial Intelligence, Cybersecurity, and Misinformation; Public Opinion and Political Trust; Causal Inference and Quantitative Methodology; Computational Social Science

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science Expected May 2028

The University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX

Dissertation: *From Digital Systems to Political Consequences: Visibility, Liability, and Institutional Embedding — Evidence from Cyber Espionage, AI Failures, and AI Exports*

Committee: Pengfei Zhang and Patrick T. Brandt (Co-Chairs), Jonathan Pinckney, Natalia Lamberova

M.S. in Social Data Analytics and Research Expected December 2026

The University of Texas at Dallas, Richardson, TX

M.A. in International Studies August 2020

Chung-Ang University, Seoul, South Korea

Selected as Graduate Representative

Exchange Student in International Studies August 2019 – January 2020

Middlebury Institute of International Studies at Monterey, Monterey, CA

B.A. in Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language July 2016

Kunming University of Science and Technology, Kunming, China

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

Pengfei Zhang, Humza Khan, and **Jing Tao**. “The Deterrence Effect of the Budapest Convention on Cybercrime Revisited: Empirical Findings and Lessons for the UN Convention.” *R&R at Journal of Cyber Policy*.

UNDER REVIEW

Jing Tao. “When Cyber Conflict Hits Home: Cyber Espionage Disclosure and Institutional Confidence.” *Under review at International Journal of Public Opinion Research*.

WORKING PAPERS

Jing Tao. “Holding AI Liable? An Experimental Study of Public Opinion on AI Safety.”

Jing Tao. “Importing Surveillance: AI Technology Transfers and Digital State Control.”

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND PRESENTATIONS

“Importing Surveillance: AI Technology Transfers and Digital State Control.”

Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference, 2026. *Forthcoming, November 2026*.

“When Cyber Espionage Goes Public: Disclosure Shocks and Citizen Confidence in Institutions.”

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, 2026.

“Fiscal Centralization and Local Public Service in China.”

Southern Political Science Association (SPSA) Annual Conference, 2026. *Accepted for presentation; not presented.*

“Arrests, Tunnels, and Trump: The Politics of Border Security in the 2024 Election.”

Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA) Annual Conference, 2025.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Editorial Assistant, *Political Analysis*

Fall 2026 – Present

Editor-in-Chief: Patrick T. Brandt

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

GOVT 2306: State and Local Government

Summer 2026

Teaching Assistant

PPPE 6353 / ECON 6362: Industry, Technology, and Science Policy

Spring 2026

PSCI / PPOL / ECON 4325: Digital Economics and the Law

Spring 2026

PPPE / PSCI 6303: Cyber Security Policy

Fall 2025

EPPS 6313: Introduction to Quantitative Methods

Fall 2025

GOVT 2305: American National Government

Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2025

GOVT 2306: State and Local Government

Fall 2024

PSCI 3350: Comparative Politics

Spring 2024

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant to Pengfei Zhang

Summer 2025

Analyzed experimental data on misinformation and fact-checking interventions; extended analyses to additional treatment conditions, examined response time and accuracy, and conducted mixed-effects logistic regression and treatment-group comparisons.

Research Assistant to Pengfei Zhang

Summer 2024

Developed a coding framework and codebook for Lumen Database DMCA takedown notices by synthesizing prior research and operationalizing variables related to notice characteristics, statutory compliance, senders, targets, and platform responses.

COMPUTATIONAL PROJECTS

Cyber Operations Incident Database (COID)

Spring 2026

Designed and implemented a normalized relational database of state-sponsored cyber operations using the CFR Cyber Operations Tracker. Built the relational schema, ETL pipeline, and analytical query infrastructure using PostgreSQL, SQL, Python, pandas, and psycopg2. [GitHub Repository](#)

The Cyber Conflict Globe: Dynamic 3D Visualization of State-Linked Operations

Fall 2025

Project Lead

Conceived and led the project from idea development to final product. Designed the overall research and visualization architecture, coordinated the data workflow, and independently developed the full JavaScript implementation for the interactive 3D globe, automatic rotation, temporal animation, and user controls using the ArcGIS API for JavaScript. [Video Demo](#)

AWARDS, SCHOLARSHIPS & CERTIFICATIONS

Brian J. L. Berry Scholar, The University of Texas at Dallas	2023–Present
Academic Scholarship, Chung-Ang University	2018–2020
First-Class Scholarship, Kunming University of Science and Technology	2016
Certificate of Accreditation in Teaching Chinese as a Foreign Language	2015
National Computer Rank Examination – MS Office Advanced Applications	2015

SKILLS

Programming & Statistical Software: R, Python, Stata, SQL, JavaScript

Data & Computational Tools: PostgreSQL, ArcGIS, Git/GitHub, L^AT_EX

Quantitative Methods: Causal Inference, Survey Experiments, Conjoint Analysis, Panel Data Methods, Matching and Weighting, Computational Social Science

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), Korean (Conversational)

REFERENCES

Pengfei Zhang

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